NEAT BRAND TRADE

Complete Product, Marketplace, Procurement and Distribution Platform Blueprint

---

1. PRODUCT VISION

Neat Brand Trade should become a digital purchasing and distribution platform designed for businesses, procurement officers, institutions and repeat commercial buyers.

The platform should allow a customer to:

1. discover products;
2. see availability;
3. select quantities quickly;
4. request a quotation where necessary;
5. submit an order;
6. upload a company purchase order;
7. receive professional commercial documents;
8. make payment;
9. use available account credit;
10. track fulfilment;
11. communicate directly with Neat Brand Trade;
12. receive and confirm delivery;
13. reorder previously purchased items.

The buyer should never need to:

- find manufacturers;
- communicate with suppliers;
- know where products were sourced;
- manage separate orders from different manufacturers;
- make separate payments;
- chase different suppliers;
- understand the supply chain behind the product.

To the buyer, Neat Brand Trade is the single commercial relationship.

The internal supply chain remains completely invisible.

---

2. THE BUSINESS MODEL

The operating structure should be:

MANUFACTURERS / SUPPLIERS

↓

NEAT BRAND TRADE

↓

BUSINESS BUYERS

The platform therefore has two major sides.

Customer-facing side

This includes:

- the public website;
- business registration;
- product discovery;
- customer portal;
- ordering;
- quotations;
- invoices;
- payment;
- account credit;
- messaging;
- delivery tracking;
- purchase history.

Internal operating side

This includes:

- product management;
- inventory;
- order processing;
- customer management;
- marketer management;
- payment reconciliation;
- refunds;
- commercial documents;

- delivery coordination;
- reporting;
- audit history.

Suppliers are not part of the buyer-facing experience.

Supplier management may eventually exist as an internal module, but it should only be visible to authorised Neat Brand Trade staff.

---

3. THE MAIN PRODUCT PRINCIPLE

Every major feature should be judged against one question:

Does this reduce the effort required to buy?

The target should be:

First-time buyer

A customer should be able to create an account and place a simple order without unnecessary steps.

Returning buyer

A returning buyer should be able to reorder within approximately 30 seconds.

Experienced procurement officer

A procurement officer who already knows what they need should be able to:

- search;
- enter quantities;
- confirm delivery location;
- submit.

The platform should not force every user through an ecommerce-style browsing process.

Different buyers behave differently.

Therefore, Neat Brand Trade should provide multiple buying methods.

---

4. CUSTOMER TYPES

The platform should serve several customer groups.

4.1 Small business buyers

Examples:

- salons;
- restaurants;
- small offices;
- retail businesses;
- cleaning businesses.

They may purchase directly with little internal approval.

4.2 Medium and large organisations

Examples:

- hotels;
- hospitals;
- schools;
- factories;
- construction companies;
- corporate offices.

They may need:

- quotations;
- multiple users;
- purchase orders;
- approvals;
- payment terms;
- statements;
- delivery documentation.

4.3 Procurement officers

These users prioritise:

- speed;
- specifications;
- pricing;
- availability;
- documentation;
- accountability;
- repeat ordering.

They usually care less about lifestyle-style ecommerce presentation.

4.4 Institutional customers

These may require:

- quotation first;
- proforma invoice;
- official purchase order;
- contract pricing;
- credit terms;
- multiple delivery destinations;
- internal approval.

4.5 Walk-in or self-service buyers

These customers discover the platform through the public website and register themselves.

They should enter through the same customer system as customers onboarded by marketers.

The only difference should be acquisition source.

---

5. CUSTOMER ACQUISITION SOURCES

Every customer record should store how the customer entered the business.

Possible acquisition sources:

- marketer;
- public website;
- admin-created;
- referral;
- campaign;
- existing customer referral;
- manual import.

Example:

Acquisition source: Marketer
Acquired by: Kwame Mensah
Acquisition date: 5 July 2026

Or:

Acquisition source: Website Self Registration

This information should remain permanently attached to the organisation.

---

6. USER AND ACCOUNT ARCHITECTURE

The most important structural decision is this:

Accounts should be organisation-based, not simply user-based.

The system should not assume:

USER → ORDER

The structure should be:

ORGANISATION

↓

ORGANISATION MEMBERS

↓

ORDERS, ADDRESSES, PAYMENTS AND DOCUMENTS

Example:

Golden View Hotel

Members:

- Procurement Officer;
- Finance Officer;
- General Manager.

Delivery locations:

- Main Hotel;
- Central Warehouse;
- Laundry Department.

Orders:

- Order NBT-2026-00122;
- Order NBT-2026-00146.

All activity belongs to the organisation.

This allows the platform to grow into a serious B2B procurement system.

---

7. SYSTEM ROLES

The platform should support structured role-based access.

7.1 SUPER ADMIN

The Super Admin owns the entire platform.

The Super Admin can:

- create internal users;
- suspend internal users;
- assign roles;
- create marketers;
- manage all customers;
- approve accounts;
- manage products;
- manage categories;
- manage pricing;
- create customer-specific prices;
- manage inventory;
- adjust inventory;
- receive orders;
- confirm orders;
- reject orders;
- cancel orders;
- create quotations;
- create invoices;
- manage payments;
- manage customer credit;
- approve refunds;
- manage deliveries;
- access all messages;
- access reports;

- manage platform settings;
- manage document templates;
- manage taxes;
- manage payment settings;
- view audit logs.

The Super Admin must have the strongest security level.

7.2 OPERATIONS ADMIN

The Operations Admin handles fulfilment.

Permissions may include:

- view orders;
- review new orders;
- reserve stock;
- confirm availability;
- update fulfilment status;
- prepare dispatch;
- assign delivery;
- update delivery information;
- communicate with customers.

The Operations Admin should not automatically have permission to:

- change financial balances;
- approve large refunds;
- change platform roles;
- delete audit records.

7.3 FINANCE OFFICER

The Finance Officer manages:

- invoices;
- payment records;
- customer account statements;
- payment verification;
- account credit;
- refund processing;
- credit notes;
- outstanding balances;

- debt ageing.

The Finance Officer should not automatically be able to change physical stock.

7.4 INVENTORY / WAREHOUSE USER

This user manages:

- receiving stock;
- stock transfers;
- inventory adjustments;
- picking;
- packing;
- reserved stock;
- damaged stock;
- dispatch confirmation.

7.5 MARKETER / AGENT

The marketer has one primary job:

Acquire and onboard customers.

The marketer should not:

- manage orders;
- edit prices;
- communicate on behalf of operations;
- fulfil orders;
- access customer financial balances;
- manage refunds.

The marketer can:

- create customer organisations;
- create the initial contact;
- send onboarding invitation;
- see customers personally onboarded;
- see basic performance statistics.

After onboarding, the customer's commercial relationship becomes a Neat Brand Trade relationship.

7.6 CUSTOMER ORGANISATION ADMIN

This is the main administrator for the customer company.

They can:

- update company information;
- manage company members;
- manage delivery addresses;
- place orders;
- view orders;
- access documents;
- make payments;
- view account credit;
- communicate with Neat Brand Trade;
- manage saved procurement lists.

7.7 CUSTOMER PROCUREMENT USER

Can:

- browse;
- create baskets;
- create orders;
- request quotations;
- upload purchase orders;
- view company purchase history.

Depending on company settings, orders may require internal approval.

7.8 CUSTOMER APPROVER

Can:

- review internal purchase requests;
- approve;
- reject;
- request changes.

7.9 CUSTOMER FINANCE USER

Can:

- view invoices;
- make payments;
- view payment history;
- view account statements.

---

8. CUSTOMER ONBOARDING

There should be two onboarding methods.

8.1 MARKETER-ASSISTED ONBOARDING

The marketer visits a potential customer.

The marketer opens:

ADD NEW BUSINESS

The minimum initial information should be:

- company name;
- contact person's name;
- mobile number;
- optional email;
- business type;
- region;
- city.

The marketer submits.

The system:

1. creates the organisation;
2. records the marketer attribution;
3. creates the primary customer contact;
4. sends an invitation by SMS;
5. customer enters OTP;
6. customer completes the remaining profile.

The marketer should not need to create or communicate a password.

8.2 SELF-ONBOARDING

The public website should include:

REGISTER MY BUSINESS

The buyer enters:

- phone number;
- OTP;
- company name;
- contact person.

The account should be created immediately.

The remaining company details can be completed progressively.

This avoids a long registration form before the user sees the platform.

---

9. FIREBASE AUTHENTICATION

All identity and account authentication should use Firebase Authentication as requested.

Customers should primarily use:

Phone number + OTP

Firebase supports phone authentication by SMS OTP on the web. The web implementation requires the relevant authorised-domain and anti-abuse setup.

Recommended authentication methods:

Customers

Phone OTP.

Optional later:

- phone + linked email;
- Google sign-in.

Staff

Email/password or Google login.

Super Admin

Email-based login with stronger authentication and MFA.

Phone-only authentication should not be the only protection for high-privilege administrative accounts.

Firebase supports provider-based authentication, custom role claims and role-aware access controls.

---

10. FIREBASE ROLE MANAGEMENT

Firebase should handle identity.

The backend should store business permissions.

Recommended architecture:

Firebase Authentication:

- confirms who the person is.

Application database:

- confirms what organisation the person belongs to;
- confirms what role the person has;
- confirms what they are allowed to do.

Firebase custom claims should be used only for high-level access such as:

- super_admin;
- internal_staff;
- customer.

Detailed business permissions should remain in PostgreSQL.

Example:

Firebase:

role = internal_staff

PostgreSQL:

operations.read_orders = true
operations.update_order = true
finance.issue_refund = false

This prevents the Firebase authentication record from becoming the entire permission system.

---

11. THE PUBLIC WEBSITE

The current website already promotes wholesale purchasing, business registration, invoices, product categories and delivery. The next redesign should push the platform more clearly toward business procurement rather than a normal online chemical shop.

The public site should have five purposes:

1. explain what NBT supplies;
2. establish trust;
3. allow product discovery;
4. acquire business accounts;
5. lead existing customers to login.

---

12. RECOMMENDED PUBLIC NAVIGATION

Main navigation:

- Products
- Industries
- How It Works
- Bulk & Corporate Supply
- About
- Contact

Actions:

- Search
- Login
- Register Business

The main CTA should be:

REGISTER YOUR BUSINESS

Existing customers should see:

LOGIN TO BUY

---

13. PUBLIC HOMEPAGE STRUCTURE

Hero

Headline:

Everything Your Business Needs. One Reliable Supply Partner.

Supporting statement:

Browse available products, order directly, receive professional documents, pay securely and track every delivery from one account.

Actions:

REGISTER MY BUSINESS

BROWSE PRODUCTS

Search

A large product search bar should appear high on the page.

Search:

- product;
- category;
- brand;
- use;
- specification.

Shop by industry

Examples:

- Hotels;
- Restaurants;
- Hospitals;
- Schools;

- Offices;
- Factories;
- Cleaning Companies;
- Construction.

Popular categories

Best-selling products

How NBT works

1. Create business account.
2. Select products.
3. Confirm delivery.
4. Pay or use available credit.
5. Track fulfilment.

Why businesses use NBT

- one supply partner;
- visible availability;
- quick repeat ordering;
- professional documents;
- payment tracking;
- delivery tracking;
- account history.

Corporate procurement section

For procurement teams requiring:

- quotations;
- purchase orders;
- account statements;
- bulk pricing;
- repeat procurement lists.

---

14. PRODUCT DISCOVERY

Product discovery should support multiple buying behaviours.

There should be four purchasing modes.

14.1 VISUAL PRODUCT GRID

Best for first-time users.

Product card:

Product Image

Industrial Liquid Soap

25L

GHS 250

IN STOCK

− 1 +

ADD

The quantity selector should be directly on the card.

The user should not have to open the product page before adding it.

14.2 COMPACT PROCUREMENT VIEW

For frequent buyers.

Columns:

Product
Pack Size
SKU
Price
Availability

Quantity
Add

This allows rapid purchasing.

14.3 QUICK ORDER

A dedicated rapid purchasing interface.

The customer searches:

Bleach

Results appear.

They select:

Bleach 5L

Quantity:

20

Then search:

Tissue

Add:

5 cartons

The current order remains visible.

This should allow a complete order without navigating between product pages.

14.4 BUY AGAIN

The system should learn from previous orders.

The logged-in buyer homepage should show:

BUY AGAIN

Examples:

Liquid Soap 25L
Last purchased: 15 June
Previous quantity: 10

REORDER

The buyer should also be able to:

REORDER ENTIRE ORDER

---

15. PRODUCT CARD INFORMATION

Each card should show:

- image;
- product name;
- pack size;
- starting or exact price;
- stock availability;
- quantity selector;
- add button.

Optional:

- favourite;
- compare;
- contract price badge.

Do not overload product cards with long descriptions.

---

16. PRODUCT DETAIL PAGE

The detailed page should include:

- product name;
- images;
- product code;
- brand;
- unit;

- pack size;
- available stock status;
- price;
- quantity;
- volume discount;
- short description;
- full specification;
- applications;
- usage information;
- product documents;
- delivery information;
- related products.

For industrial chemicals:

- Technical Data Sheet;
- Safety Data Sheet;
- certificate;
- dilution guidance.

---

17. PRODUCT VARIANTS

A product may have several variants.

Example:

Liquid Soap:

- 5L;
- 25L;
- 50L;
- 200L.

Each variant should have:

- separate SKU;
- separate price;
- separate stock;
- separate barcode;
- separate reorder threshold.

---

18. PRODUCT SEARCH

Search should recognise:

- exact product name;
- generic product name;
- category;
- brand;
- SKU;
- intended use;
- synonyms.

Example:

A customer searches:

“Toilet cleaner”

The system should still find:

- Washroom Descaler;
- Acidic Toilet Cleaner;
- Bathroom Cleaner.

Search quality is one of the most important features in the whole platform.

---

19. INDUSTRY COLLECTIONS

Products should also be grouped by business use.

Example:

Hotel Essentials

- housekeeping products;
- laundry products;
- tissue;
- washroom products;
- kitchen cleaners.

School Hygiene

- hand wash;
- disinfectants;

- tissue;
- floor cleaner.

Factory Cleaning

- degreasers;
- industrial cleaners;
- hand cleaners.

This helps buyers who know their business problem but not the exact product.

---

20. CUSTOMER-SPECIFIC PRICING

The platform should support several pricing models.

- public price;
- standard business price;
- bulk price;
- contract price;
- customer-specific price.

Example:

Standard price: GHS 100

Customer A contract price: GHS 90

Customer B volume price: GHS 84

The logged-in buyer should always see their applicable price.

The system must keep a record of:

- price;
- pricing rule;
- effective date;
- expiry date;
- person who approved it.

---

21. VOLUME PRICING

Products can support price breaks.

Example:

1–9 units: GHS 100

10–49 units: GHS 95

50+ units: GHS 88

The customer should see their price update immediately as quantity changes.

---

22. STOCK VISIBILITY

Customers should see product availability.

Recommended statuses:

- In Stock;
- Low Stock;
- Available on Order;
- Out of Stock;
- Temporarily Unavailable.

Exact quantities can be shown only when commercially appropriate.

Example:

IN STOCK

or:

43 AVAILABLE

The system must use available stock, not physical stock.

Physical stock: 100

Reserved: 30

Available: 70

Customer sees:

70 available.

---

23. OUT-OF-STOCK PRODUCTS

Out-of-stock products should remain visible.

Never simply remove them.

Options:

NOTIFY ME

REQUEST AVAILABILITY

ADD ALTERNATIVE

This allows the business to measure unmet demand.

---

24. SAVED PRODUCTS

Customers should be able to save products.

Possible collections:

- Favourites;
- Monthly Supplies;
- Hotel Essentials;
- Branch Supplies.

---

25. PROCUREMENT LISTS

Customers should create reusable purchasing lists.

Example:

MONTHLY HOUSEKEEPING ORDER

- Liquid Soap × 20;
- Tissue × 10;
- Floor Cleaner × 8.

The customer can:

REORDER LIST

Then:

- adjust quantities;
- choose delivery location;
- submit.

---

26. REORDERING

Reordering should exist at several levels.

- reorder product;
- reorder procurement list;
- reorder previous order;
- reorder selected items from previous order.

---

27. BULK ORDER IMPORT

Procurement officers should be able to upload:

- Excel;
- CSV.

Columns:

Product
SKU
Quantity

The system should:

1. parse the file;
2. match products;
3. identify unknown products;
4. allow correction;
5. create a draft order.

Example:

23 products matched.

2 products need clarification.

28. REQUEST FOR QUOTATION

Not every customer should be forced to buy immediately.

A customer can:

REQUEST QUOTATION

They select:

- products;
- quantities;
- delivery location;
- required date.

NBT reviews the request.

The customer receives:

QUOTATION READY

They can:

ACCEPT QUOTATION

After acceptance:

the system converts it into an order.

29. SHOPPING CART VS ORDER BUILDER

The customer interface should use:

MY ORDER

rather than only:

CART

For B2B users, the language should feel commercial.

The order drawer should remain visible while browsing.

Example:

MY ORDER

7 products

GHS 4,850

VIEW ORDER

---

30. CHECKOUT

Checkout should be as short as possible.

The buyer should only confirm:

Deliver To

Saved delivery location.

Contact Person

Existing contact or new contact.

Preferred Delivery Date

Optional.

Company Reference

Optional PO number or internal reference.

Payment Method

Payment now, account credit or payment terms.

Notes

Optional.

Then:

SUBMIT ORDER

---

31. DELIVERY ADDRESS STRUCTURE

Every organisation can save several locations.

Each location should have:

- name;
- region;
- city;
- address;
- digital address;
- map coordinates;
- contact person;
- mobile number;
- delivery instructions.

Examples:

HEAD OFFICE

TEMA WAREHOUSE

KUMASI BRANCH

---

32. ORDER LIFECYCLE

Internal statuses should be detailed.

Recommended lifecycle:

DRAFT

↓

SUBMITTED

↓

UNDER REVIEW

↓

CONFIRMED

↓

AWAITING PAYMENT

↓

PAID / PAYMENT TERMS APPROVED

↓

PROCESSING

↓

PICKING

↓

PACKED

↓

READY FOR DISPATCH

↓

DISPATCHED

↓

IN TRANSIT

↓

DELIVERED

↓

COMPLETED

Additional statuses:

- Partially Fulfilled;
- On Hold;
- Cancelled;
- Returned;
- Refunded.

---

33. CUSTOMER-FACING STATUS

Customers do not need every internal warehouse status.

They should see a simpler timeline.

ORDER RECEIVED

↓

CONFIRMED

↓

PROCESSING

↓

DISPATCHED

↓

DELIVERED

Internal complexity stays hidden.

---

34. STATUS HISTORY

Every status change must record:

- previous status;
- new status;
- timestamp;
- user;

• optional note.

The history should never simply be overwritten.

---

35. ORDER REVIEW

When an order arrives, admin should see:

• customer;
• products;
• requested quantities;
• available quantities;
• customer price;
• payment terms;
• delivery destination;
• previous balance;
• attached PO;
• customer notes.

Admin actions:

CONFIRM ALL

ADJUST ORDER

PARTIALLY CONFIRM

REQUEST CLARIFICATION

CANCEL

---

36. ORDER CHANGES

After a customer submits an order, changes should not happen invisibly.

If quantity changes:

Original:

20 units

Revised:

18 units

Reason:

2 units unavailable.

The customer should see the revision.

For material changes, the customer should approve.

---

37. STOCK RESERVATION

When should stock become reserved?

Recommended rule:

Submitted order

Soft reservation for a defined period.

Confirmed or paid order

Firm reservation.

Reservations should expire under defined rules.

This prevents dead orders from locking inventory forever.

---

38. COMMERCIAL DOCUMENTS

The system should automatically generate professional commercial documents.

Required document types:

- Quotation;
- Proforma Invoice;
- Sales Order;
- Tax Invoice;
- Receipt;
- Delivery Note;
- Credit Note;
- Customer Statement.

39. PURCHASE ORDER HANDLING

Important terminology:

A purchase order normally comes from the buyer.

Therefore the system should support:

UPLOAD PURCHASE ORDER

The customer can enter:

PO Number

and upload:

- PDF;
- image;
- Word document.

For customers without an internal PO system, Neat Brand Trade can create:

PURCHASE REQUEST SUMMARY

This should not automatically be mislabelled as the customer's official PO.

40. DOCUMENT NUMBERING

Example:

Order:

NBT-ORD-2026-000123

Quotation:

NBT-QT-2026-000123

Invoice:

NBT-INV-2026-000123

Delivery Note:

NBT-DN-2026-000123

Credit Note:

NBT-CN-2026-000123

Receipt:

NBT-RCPT-2026-000123

The numbering rules should be configurable.

---

41. DOCUMENT DESIGN

Documents should contain:

- NBT logo;
- company legal information;
- customer information;
- billing address;
- delivery address;
- document number;
- order reference;
- customer PO reference;
- issue date;
- due date;
- product table;
- unit price;
- quantity;
- discount;
- tax;
- delivery fees;
- total;
- paid amount;
- outstanding amount;
- payment terms;
- bank/payment details;
- authorised notes.

Documents should be:

- viewable;
- downloadable;

- printable;
- shareable.

---

42. DOCUMENT VERSION CONTROL

If an invoice or quotation changes, do not simply overwrite it.

Store:

Version 1

Version 2

Version 3

The audit trail should record who created the revision and why.

---

43. PAYMENT SYSTEM

Paystack should be the main online payment infrastructure.

The platform can support payment channels offered through Paystack in the relevant market, including supported Ghana mobile money channels and cards. Final payment status should be confirmed server-side rather than trusting only the browser redirect.

Payment options:

- Mobile Money;
- Card;
- Account Credit;
- Manual Bank Transfer;
- Approved Credit Terms.

---

44. PAYSTACK PAYMENT FLOW

Recommended flow:

1. Customer selects Pay Now.
2. Server creates transaction.
3. Customer completes payment.

4. Paystack sends payment event.
5. Backend verifies authenticity.
6. Payment record changes to successful.
7. Invoice/order is updated.
8. Customer receives confirmation.

Webhook events should be verified before processing. Paystack documents signature verification for webhook origin, and its documentation recommends webhooks for reliable asynchronous status updates.

---

45. PAYMENT RECORDS

Every payment should store:

- payment reference;
- order;
- invoice;
- organisation;
- amount;
- payment channel;
- payment provider;
- payment status;
- initiated date;
- successful date;
- provider response.

Payment status examples:

- Pending;
- Successful;
- Failed;
- Reversed;
- Refunded;
- Partially Refunded.

---

46. PARTIAL PAYMENTS

The system should support:

Invoice total: GHS 10,000

Paid: GHS 6,000

Outstanding: GHS 4,000

The invoice remains partially paid.

---

47. PAYMENT ALLOCATION

One payment may settle:

- one invoice;
- several invoices.

Example:

GHS 20,000 payment

Allocated:

Invoice 102: GHS 5,000

Invoice 103: GHS 7,000

Invoice 105: GHS 8,000

This matters for future corporate accounts.

---

48. CUSTOMER ACCOUNT CREDIT

The recommended approach is not to present the system immediately as a bank-style wallet.

Use:

NBT ACCOUNT CREDIT

The customer can have a positive credit balance.

Example:

AVAILABLE CREDIT

GHS 12,450

They can use it to purchase.

Sources of credit:

- advance deposit;
- overpayment;
- approved refund;
- promotional credit;
- manual financial adjustment.

---

49. LEDGER ARCHITECTURE

Never store only:

balance = 5000

The system must store every balance movement.

Example:

- GHS 10,000 Deposit

- GHS 2,500 Order 123

- GHS 1,000 Order 126

- GHS 500 Refund Credit

Available balance:

GHS 7,000

The ledger is the financial truth.

---

50. ACCOUNT CREDIT CHECKOUT

Customer sees:

Available credit:

GHS 5,000

Order:

GHS 1,200

Payment:

USE ACCOUNT CREDIT

Confirm.

System records:

- debit ledger entry;
- order payment;
- new balance.

---

51. SPLIT PAYMENT

Later:

Order total:

GHS 8,000

Account credit:

GHS 3,000

Customer can use:

GHS 3,000 credit

plus:

GHS 5,000 Paystack payment.

---

52. REFUNDS

Refund options:

- original payment method;
- NBT Account Credit.

Paystack supports full and partial refund workflows, and refund states should be tracked asynchronously.

Refund record:

- original payment;
- order;
- customer;
- amount;
- refund method;
- reason;
- requested by;
- approved by;
- status.

---

53. REFUND APPROVAL

Recommended workflow:

REQUESTED

↓

UNDER REVIEW

↓

APPROVED

↓

PROCESSING

↓

COMPLETED

or

REJECTED

Large refunds may require Super Admin approval.

---

54. CREDIT TERMS

Approved business customers can receive:

- Pay Before Fulfilment;
- 50% Deposit;
- 7 Days;
- 14 Days;
- 30 Days.

The account should contain:

Credit limit:

GHS 50,000

Outstanding:

GHS 30,000

Available credit:

GHS 20,000

The platform must prevent the customer exceeding approved credit without authorisation.

---

55. CUSTOMER STATEMENT

Every organisation should have a statement.

Example:

Opening Balance

Invoices

Payments

Credits

Refunds

Closing Balance

Download PDF.

---

56. DIRECT MESSAGING

The platform should have built-in communication between the customer and NBT.

Messaging categories:

- General Support;
- Order Conversation;
- Product Enquiry.

---

57. ORDER CONVERSATIONS

Every order should have a message thread.

Example:

Order NBT-2026-00123

Customer:

Can 10 cartons be delivered today?

Admin:

Yes. The remaining quantity will arrive Friday.

This prevents communication from being separated from the transaction.

---

58. ATTACHMENTS

Users should be able to attach:

- images;
- PDF;
- Word documents;
- spreadsheets.

Firebase Cloud Storage can be used for uploaded files, with access controlled by authentication and security rules. Firebase Storage rules can also validate file properties such as size and content type.

---

59. MESSAGE NOTIFICATIONS

New message notifications can appear through:

- in-app notification;
- email;
- optional SMS;
- optional WhatsApp integration later.

---

60. INVENTORY MANAGEMENT

Inventory should support:

- warehouses;
- products;
- variants;
- stock levels;
- reservations;
- incoming stock;
- damaged stock;
- stock movements.

---

61. STOCK QUANTITIES

For every product variant:

Physical Stock

Reserved Stock

Available Stock

Incoming Stock

Damaged Stock

Available Stock:

Physical Stock - Reserved Stock

---

62. INVENTORY MOVEMENTS

Every change should create a movement.

Movement types:

- Opening Stock;
- Goods Received;
- Sale;
- Reservation;
- Reservation Release;
- Return;
- Damage;
- Adjustment;
- Transfer.

---

63. STOCK ADJUSTMENTS

Admin should never simply type a new stock number without reason.

Example:

Previous stock:

100

New stock:

95

Adjustment:

-5

Reason:

Damaged during handling.

User:

Warehouse Manager.

Timestamp.

---

64. MULTIPLE WAREHOUSES

Build the architecture for multiple warehouses from day one.

Example:

Accra Warehouse

Tema Warehouse

Kumasi Warehouse

Even if only one warehouse exists at launch.

---

65. ORDER FULFILMENT

Warehouse workflow:

NEW ORDER

↓

STOCK RESERVED

↓

PICK LIST CREATED

↓

ITEMS PICKED

↓

PACKED

↓

DISPATCH READY

The system can generate a pick list.

---

66. PARTIAL FULFILMENT

Example:

Ordered:

100 units

Available:

80 units

Options:

- fulfil 80 now;
- fulfil remaining 20 later;
- customer accepts substitution;
- customer cancels unavailable quantity.

The system should support multiple deliveries against one order.

---

67. DELIVERY MANAGEMENT

Every delivery should have:

- order;
- destination;
- contact person;
- contact number;
- delivery method;
- assigned driver;
- vehicle;
- dispatch time;
- expected delivery;
- delivery status.

---

68. DELIVERY STATUS

- Awaiting Dispatch;
- Dispatched;
- In Transit;
- Delivery Attempted;
- Delivered;
- Failed Delivery.

---

69. PROOF OF DELIVERY

Delivery confirmation may include:

- recipient name;
- signature;
- photograph;
- timestamp;
- GPS;
- delivery notes.

The customer should be able to view proof of delivery from the order.

---

70. CUSTOMER DASHBOARD

The customer dashboard should prioritise purchasing.

Recommended home screen:

GOOD MORNING, JOHN

Search products...

Quick actions:

- Reorder;
- Browse Products;
- Quick Order;
- Upload Purchase List;
- Track Orders.

Needs Attention

- 2 invoices awaiting payment;
- 1 order dispatched;
- 1 quotation awaiting acceptance.

Buy Again

Frequently purchased items.

Recent Orders

Order number
Date
Value
Status
Action

Available Account Credit

GHS 4,500

---

71. CUSTOMER NAVIGATION

Recommended:

- Home;
- Products;
- My Orders;
- Procurement Lists;
- Payments;
- Documents;
- Messages;
- Company.

---

72. ORDER DETAILS PAGE

The order page should show:

- order number;
- status;
- timeline;
- products;
- quantities;
- prices;
- total;
- payments;
- delivery details;
- documents;
- messages;
- activity history.

---

73. CUSTOMER COMPANY SETTINGS

Organisation profile:

- legal name;
- trading name;
- registration details;
- tax information;
- billing address;
- phone;
- email;
- industry.

---

74. MULTIPLE CUSTOMER USERS

Organisation Admin can:

INVITE TEAM MEMBER

Select role:

- Procurement;
- Approver;
- Finance;
- Viewer.

75. CUSTOMER INTERNAL APPROVAL WORKFLOW

Optional feature.

Procurement officer creates request.

↓

Manager approves.

↓

Order submitted to NBT.

This should be an organisation-level setting.

Simple businesses can keep approval disabled.

---

76. MARKETER DASHBOARD

The marketer dashboard should remain deliberately simple.

Home:

MY PERFORMANCE

Customers Onboarded

Active Customers

Customers Who Ordered

Total Order Value From My Customers

My Customers

Columns:

- Company;
- Contact;

• Joined;
• Orders;
• Last Order;
• Status.

Add Customer

The primary action.

---

77. MARKETER ATTRIBUTION

Every marketer-created organisation stores:

acquired_by_marketer_id

acquired_at

acquisition_channel

This remains in the database.

Future commission rules can use this data.

---

78. SUPER ADMIN DASHBOARD

The Super Admin home should be an operational command centre.

Not a wall of decorative charts.

Needs Attention

7 New Orders

4 Orders Awaiting Payment

3 Delivery Issues

2 Refund Requests

6 New Messages

9 Low-Stock Products

Live Order Pipeline

New

Confirmed

Processing

Ready

Dispatched

Delivered

Today's Financial Activity

Orders

Payments

Refunds

Outstanding Invoices

Today's Operations

Orders received

Orders dispatched

Orders delivered

---

79. ADMIN NAVIGATION

Recommended:

Dashboard

Orders

Customers

Products

Inventory

Payments

Documents

Deliveries

Messages

Marketers

Reports

Settings

---

80. ADMIN ORDER MODULE

Filters:

- New;
- Under Review;
- Awaiting Payment;
- Processing;
- Dispatch Ready;
- Dispatched;
- Delivered;
- Problem Orders.

Search by:

- order number;
- company;
- customer;
- phone;
- PO number.

81. CUSTOMER MANAGEMENT

Customer record should show:

- organisation profile;
- members;
- addresses;
- account owner;
- acquisition source;
- marketer;
- pricing rules;
- credit terms;
- account balance;
- outstanding balance;
- orders;
- invoices;
- payments;
- documents;
- messages;
- notes.

82. INTERNAL NOTES

Staff should be able to add notes invisible to the customer.

Examples:

Customer requires finance approval before dispatch.

Do not deliver after 4 PM.

Contract pricing expires September.

83. CUSTOMER STATUS

Possible statuses:

- Prospect;
- Active;
- On Hold;

- Credit Restricted;
- Suspended;
- Archived.

---

84. PRODUCT ADMIN

Product management should support:

- product name;
- description;
- category;
- brand;
- variants;
- price;
- customer pricing;
- images;
- stock settings;
- documents;
- visibility.

---

85. BULK PRODUCT IMPORT

Admin should be able to upload a spreadsheet containing:

- SKU;
- product;
- category;
- variant;
- price;
- stock;
- barcode.

The system should validate before import.

---

86. PRODUCT VISIBILITY

Possible states:

- Draft;
- Published;
- Hidden;

- Out of Stock;
- Archived.

---

87. NOTIFICATIONS

Events that should create notifications:

Customer:

- order submitted;
- order confirmed;
- payment required;
- payment received;
- order dispatched;
- delivered;
- new message;
- quotation ready;
- refund update.

Admin:

- new order;
- payment received;
- customer message;
- refund request;
- low stock;
- failed delivery.

---

88. NOTIFICATION CENTRE

Every user should have:

NOTIFICATIONS

with:

- unread count;
- type;
- date;
- related order;
- mark as read.

---

89. EMAIL NOTIFICATIONS

Email can be used for:

- invoices;
- quotations;
- receipts;
- delivery notifications;
- customer statements.

---

90. SMS NOTIFICATIONS

SMS should be reserved for important events:

- OTP;
- order confirmed;
- dispatched;
- delivery issue.

This prevents unnecessary messaging costs.

---

91. WHATSAPP

WhatsApp can be added later for:

- order updates;
- delivery updates;
- customer support.

The in-platform system should remain the official record.

---

92. REPORTING

Reports should answer business questions.

92.1 SALES REPORTS

- sales by period;

• sales by customer;
• sales by product;
• sales by category;
• average order value.

92.2 CUSTOMER REPORTS

• new customers;
• active customers;
• repeat customers;
• dormant customers;
• highest-value customers.

92.3 MARKETER REPORTS

• clients onboarded;
• activated clients;
• ordering clients;
• order value from attributed clients.

92.4 INVENTORY REPORTS

• current stock;
• low stock;
• out of stock;
• slow-moving products;
• stock movement.

92.5 FINANCIAL REPORTS

• payments;
• unpaid invoices;
• outstanding balances;
• account credit liabilities;
• refunds.

---

93. AUDIT LOGGING

Every sensitive action should leave a permanent log.

Examples:

Admin changed price from GHS 100 to GHS 90.

Warehouse user adjusted stock by -5.

Finance user approved refund.

Admin changed order status.

Super Admin created staff account.

Audit entry:

- actor;
- action;
- object;
- before;
- after;
- timestamp;
- optional IP/device information.

---

94. SECURITY ARCHITECTURE

Firebase Authentication handles identity.

Application backend handles:

- permissions;
- business rules;
- order processing;
- payment logic;
- financial logic.

Firebase App Check should also be considered as an additional abuse-protection layer for supported application resources and backend requests.

---

95. RECOMMENDED TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

Frontend

Next.js

React

TypeScript

Authentication

Firebase Authentication

Main Business Database

PostgreSQL

File Storage

Firebase Cloud Storage

Payment

Paystack

Backend

Recommended:

Node.js with:

- NestJS;

or:

- structured Next.js backend services for a smaller initial build.

For this product, I would personally lean toward a dedicated backend architecture once the financial and operational features become complex.

---

96. WHY POSTGRESQL SHOULD HOLD BUSINESS DATA

This system is highly relational.

Examples:

Organisation

↓

Members

↓

Orders

↓

Order Items

↓

Invoices

↓

Payments

↓

Refunds

A relational database is appropriate for maintaining these relationships and transaction integrity.

Firebase Authentication should handle authentication.

It does not mean all business data must also be forced into Firebase.

---

97. RECOMMENDED SYSTEM FLOW

Firebase Auth

↓

Frontend

↓

Backend API

↓

PostgreSQL

Connected services:

- Paystack;
- Firebase Storage;
- notification providers.

---

98. CORE DATABASE STRUCTURE

Recommended tables:

users

organisations

organisation_members

roles

permissions

user_roles

marketers

customer_acquisitions

addresses

categories

brands

products

product_variants

product_images

product_documents

price_lists

customer_prices

warehouses

inventory

stock_movements

stock_reservations

procurement_lists

procurement_list_items

carts

cart_items

quotation_requests

quotations

quotation_items

orders

order_items

order_status_history

invoices

invoice_items

receipts

credit_notes

payments

payment_allocations

customer_accounts

account_ledger_entries

refunds

deliveries

delivery_items

proof_of_delivery

conversations

conversation_participants

messages

message_attachments

notifications

audit_logs

---

99. ORDER DATA

Each order stores:

- ID;
- order number;
- organisation;

- ordering user;
- status;
- currency;
- subtotal;
- discount;
- tax;
- delivery charge;
- total;
- payment status;
- fulfilment status;
- delivery address;
- contact person;
- customer reference;
- PO reference;
- acquisition information;
- timestamps.

---

100. FINANCIAL INTEGRITY RULES

The system should never:

- edit successful payment history;
- silently change ledger entries;
- silently overwrite invoices;
- remove refund history.

Corrections should be made through:

- reversals;
- adjustments;
- credit notes;
- new versions.

---

101. IMPORTANT EDGE CASES

The platform should handle:

Customer pays, but browser closes

Webhook confirms payment.

Duplicate payment event

Idempotency prevents duplicate credit.

Customer submits order while stock changes

Backend revalidates stock.

Partial stock available

Partial fulfilment workflow.

Payment made but order cancelled

Refund or account credit.

Customer overpays

Excess can become account credit.

Admin makes incorrect stock adjustment

Corrective stock movement.

Customer has several locations

Order stores exact delivery location at time of purchase.

Product price changes after order

Order retains historical price.

Customer user leaves company

Remove user without deleting organisation history.

---

102. DATA PRESERVATION

Orders should store snapshots.

If a product name later changes, old invoices should still show what was purchased at the time.

Store snapshots of:

- product name;
- SKU;
- price;
- tax;
- customer details;
- delivery address.

---

103. CUSTOMER SUPPORT AND DISPUTES

An order can be flagged:

REPORT PROBLEM

Reasons:

- damaged item;
- missing item;
- wrong item;
- delivery issue;
- invoice issue.

The case becomes linked to the original order.

---

104. RETURNS

Return lifecycle:

REQUESTED

↓

REVIEWED

↓

APPROVED

↓

ITEM RECEIVED

↓

INSPECTED

↓

REFUND / CREDIT

---

105. SYSTEM SETTINGS

Super Admin should control:

- company details;
- order numbering;
- invoice numbering;
- taxes;
- payment methods;
- delivery settings;
- customer registration;
- credit rules;
- notification templates;
- file upload rules.

---

106. MVP SCOPE

The first production version should contain enough to run the real business.

Public

- homepage;
- products;
- categories;
- search;
- registration;
- login.

Customer

- OTP login;
- dashboard;
- product browsing;
- cart/order builder;

- addresses;
- order submission;
- order tracking;
- document viewing;
- payment;
- messages.

Marketer

- login;
- add customer;
- customer list;
- basic performance.

Admin

- dashboard;
- customers;
- products;
- inventory;
- orders;
- documents;
- payments;
- deliveries;
- messages.

---

107. SECOND PHASE

Add:

- procurement lists;
- buy again;
- quotations;
- customer-specific pricing;
- account credit;
- refunds;
- bulk Excel ordering;
- multiple company users.

---

108. THIRD PHASE

Add:

- internal approval workflow;
- credit limits;
- statements;
- multiple warehouses;
- advanced delivery;
- proof of delivery;
- advanced reports.

---

109. FUTURE INTELLIGENCE

Later, the platform can add intelligent purchasing features.

Examples:

You normally purchase this product every 30 days.

You may run out in 5 days.

Reorder?

The system can also identify:

- frequent products;
- likely reorder dates;
- dormant customers;
- unusual demand;
- stock risks.

---

110. WHAT NBT SHOULD NOT BECOME

Do not turn the platform into:

- a crowded supplier directory;
- an Amazon-style marketplace;
- a complex ERP customers must learn;
- a product catalogue with too many steps;
- a system where customers see internal operations.

The customer experience should remain extremely simple.

---

111. THE FINAL BUYER EXPERIENCE

A buyer logs in.

They immediately see:

Search.

Buy Again.

Quick Order.

Track Orders.

The buyer selects products.

Chooses:

Deliver to Tema Warehouse.

Selects:

Use Account Credit.

Confirms.

The order is submitted.

The buyer receives:

Order confirmation.

Professional document.

Status tracking.

Delivery notification.

Proof of delivery.

The complexity behind:

- sourcing;
- warehousing;
- stock;
- payment reconciliation;
- documentation;
- delivery;

is managed completely by Neat Brand Trade.

---

112. FINAL PRODUCT POSITIONING

The strongest description of the product is:

Neat Brand Trade is a managed B2B procurement and distribution platform that allows businesses to source products, place orders, receive commercial documents, make payments and track fulfilment through one account.

The customer does not need to manage multiple suppliers.

Neat Brand Trade becomes the single purchasing and fulfilment relationship.

---

113. FINAL RECOMMENDATION

The product should be built around five engines:

1. DISCOVERY ENGINE

Search, product catalogue and industry collections.

2. PURCHASING ENGINE

Quick order, procurement lists, quotations and reordering.

3. COMMERCIAL ENGINE

Pricing, documents, payments, account credit and refunds.

4. FULFILMENT ENGINE

Inventory, order processing, dispatch and delivery tracking.

5. RELATIONSHIP ENGINE

Customer accounts, marketers, messaging and purchasing history.

When these five systems work together, Neat Brand Trade stops being an ordinary online store.

It becomes the digital operating channel through which businesses buy from Neat Brand Trade.